Inbox System & Email Templates (Lumen & Pine Candle Co.)

2026-10-25

> This document shows how a virtual assistant supports Lumen & Pine Candle Co., a fictional online shop for hand-poured soy candles led by CEO Olivia Hartwell. All names, emails and figures are invented for this sample.

Process Name	Last Updated	Owner	Frequency	Next Review
Shared Inbox Management	2026-10-25	Jesyka, Virtual Assistant	Daily (Mon to Fri)	2027-01-25

1. The Problem

Customer questions, wholesale inquiries, supplier emails and app notifications all landed in one unsorted inbox at hello@lumenandpine.example. Order questions waited two or three days for a reply, and two wholesale inquiries were missed completely in one month.

2. Label Structure

Every email gets one label. Numbers keep the labels in priority order in the sidebar.

Label	What goes here	Handled by	Reply within
1 · Action Needed	Anything that needs a reply or a task today	VA	Same business day
2 · Waiting On	Emails where we are waiting for someone else to reply	VA	Check every 3 days
3 · Orders & Shipping	Order status questions, delivery issues, returns	VA	24 hours
4 · Wholesale	Stockist and boutique inquiries, wholesale orders	VA drafts, Olivia approves pricing	24 hours
5 · Suppliers	Wax, wick, jar and packaging suppliers	VA	48 hours
6 · Marketing & Collabs	Influencer requests, market events, press	Olivia decides, VA replies	3 business days
7 · Receipts & Finance	Invoices, receipts, payment notices	VA files, bookkeeper reviews	No reply needed
8 · Reference	Information to keep, such as store policies and account notices	VA	No reply needed

3. Automatic Filters

If an email…	Then

comes from the store's order notification address	Apply **3 · Orders & Shipping**, skip the inbox
has "wholesale", "stockist" or "bulk order" in the subject or body	Apply **4 · Wholesale**, mark as important
comes from a saved supplier domain	Apply **5 · Suppliers**
has "invoice", "receipt" or "payment received" in the subject	Apply **7 · Receipts & Finance**, skip the inbox

> Test every new filter on the last 30 days of email before turning it on, so nothing important is hidden by mistake.

4. Daily Triage Routine

Twice a day, at 9:00 AM and 3:00 PM US Eastern Time (ET). About 20 to 30 minutes each time.

1. Open the inbox and sort by oldest first.
2. For each email, choose one action: **Reply** (under 2 minutes), **Label** for later, **Forward** to Olivia, or **Archive**.
3. Reply to everything in **3 · Orders & Shipping** using the templates below.
4. Draft wholesale replies and leave them in **1 · Action Needed** for Olivia to approve.
5. Check **2 · Waiting On** and send a follow-up if there is no reply after 3 business days.
6. End with an empty inbox: every email is labeled or archived.

When to send to Olivia

- Refund requests and complaints about product safety
- Wholesale pricing, discounts or custom orders
- Press, collaboration and event invitations

5. Email Templates

TEMPLATE 1 · ORDER STATUS

Subject: Your Lumen & Pine order #[Order number]

Hi [First name],

Thanks for reaching out! Your order #[Order number] shipped on [Date] and is on its way. You can follow it here: [Tracking link].

Most orders arrive within [X] business days. If anything looks off, just reply to this email and we will sort it out.

Warmly,
The Lumen & Pine Team

TEMPLATE 2 · DELAYED SHIPMENT

Subject: A quick update on your order #[Order number]

Hi [First name],

Your candles are taking a little longer than usual to reach you, and we're sorry for the wait. The new expected delivery date is [Date]. We'll keep an eye on it and let you know if anything changes.

Thank you for your patience,
The Lumen & Pine Team

TEMPLATE 3 · WHOLESALE INQUIRY

Subject: Wholesale with Lumen & Pine

Hi [First name],

Thank you for your interest in stocking Lumen & Pine at [Store name]! I've attached our wholesale catalog with pricing and minimum order details.

Would you like to set up a short call this week to talk about which scents fit your shop? You can pick a time here: [Booking link].

Best,
[VA name], on behalf of Olivia Hartwell

TEMPLATE 4 · COLLABORATION (NOT A FIT RIGHT NOW)

Subject: Re: Collaboration with Lumen & Pine

Hi [First name],

Thank you so much for thinking of us. We're not taking on new collaborations this season, but we'd love to keep your details on file for future launches.

All the best,
The Lumen & Pine Team

TEMPLATE 5 · SUPPLIER FOLLOW-UP

Subject: Following up: order #[PO number]

Hi [First name],

Just checking in on purchase order #[PO number], sent on [Date]. Could you confirm the expected ship date?

Thank you,
[VA name], Lumen & Pine Candle Co.

6. Weekly Check

☐ All labels used correctly; no email left unlabeled

☐ Nothing in **1 · Action Needed** older than 2 days

☐ Templates updated if a question came up more than 3 times

☐ Short summary sent to Olivia every Friday

Sample project prepared by Jesyka Egonio, JEMNexaVA. Lumen & Pine Candle Co. is a fictional business.